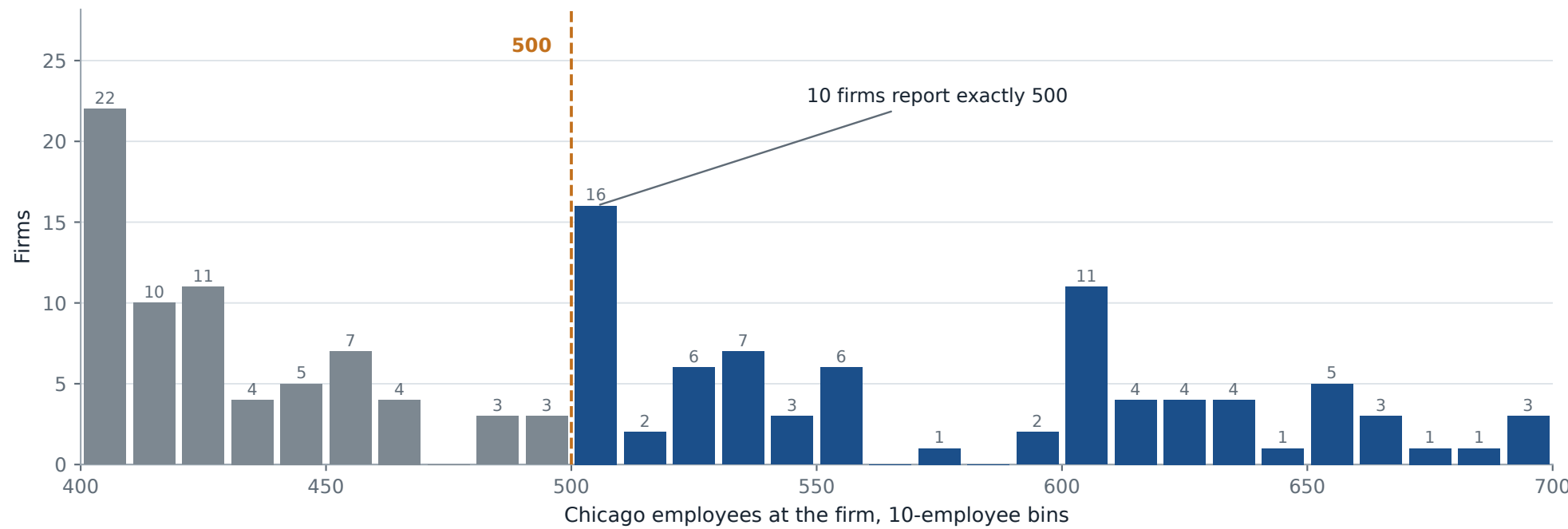


Firms heap at round headcounts, and 500 is one of them

Chicago firms with 400 to 700 employees in 2025. 243 firms are at 500 or more (10 at exactly 500); 25 drop below 500 after the remote adjustment



Firms are corporate parents (Employer's Expense Tax Ruling #2); government employers and single-location records reporting more employees than their own parent record are removed, the same base as the revenue exhibits. Employment is the 2025 Chicago headcount from the vendor file. This describes one year. No tax has ever applied at 500, so the heap at exactly 500 reflects round-number self-reporting and cannot be read as a response to a tax. The Census remote adjustment removes employees who usually work from home and live outside the city, and firms are then re-tested against 500.

Source: Data Axle (Infogroup) 2025 business file; ACS tables B08126, B08008 and B08604.